ASSIGNMENT-6 : GOOGLE ADVANCE SEARCH OPERATORS

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Q.1 Use Google advanced search operators to find all PDF files related to 'Java interview questions' from the site geeksforgeeks.org and list 3 working search queries you used.

ANS : To find PDF files related to "Java interview questions" hosted specifically on **geeksforgeeks.org**, you can use advanced Google search operators. Here are 3 working search queries designed for this purpose:

1. **Using the** filetype **operator:**

Plaintext

site:geeksforgeeks.org filetype:pdf "Java interview questions"

2. **Using the** ext **(extension) operator:**

Plaintext

site:geeksforgeeks.org ext:pdf Java interview questions

3. **Using filetype combined with file-specific URL paths/terms:**

Plaintext

site:geeksforgeeks.org/pdf/ OR site:geeksforgeeks.org filetype:pdf "Java" "interview questions"

These queries constrain the search engine to return only indexed PDF documents originating from the specified domain containing your target keywords.

Q.2 Search for Instagram bug bounty reports from the past year by using Google search operators to restrict results to the site hackerone.com and only show pages updated in 2023.Hint: Use 'site:' and 'inurl:' along with a date filter.

ANS : To find public disclosure reports for Instagram or Meta bug bounties on HackerOne, you can use Google's advanced search operators along with search parameters.

Here are the search queries you can use:

1. **Restricting to HackerOne reports mentioning Instagram:**

Plaintext

site:hackerone.com/reports "Instagram"

2. **Narrowing results to specific vulnerability types or Meta's program:**

Plaintext

site:hackerone.com inurl:reports "Meta" OR "Instagram"

To filter results specifically by date range in Google, you can use Google's built-in search tools menu (selecting **Tools > Any time > Custom range**) or append the URL parameter &tbs=cdr:1,cd_min:1/1/2023,cd_max:12/31/2023 to your search results URL to restrict indexed pages to a specific timeframe.

Q.3 Find Flipkart coupon pages that are not linked from the main site by using Google dorking techniques to search for 'coupon' in the URL but exclude results containing 'expired'.

ANS : To find unlinked or specific coupon pages on Flipkart while filtering out outdated pages, you can construct a targeted Google dork using URL filtering and exclusion operators.

The Google Dork Query

Plaintext

site:flipkart.com inurl:coupon -expired

How It Works

- site:flipkart.com
    - **What it does:** Restricts the search scope exclusively to the official Flipkart domain and its subdomains, ensuring Google only indexes content from their servers.
- inurl:coupon
    - **What it does:** Filters results to only show pages where the URL string contains the keyword "coupon". This is useful for finding hidden, direct, or directory-structured promotional and discount pages
- -expired
    - **What it does:** The minus sign (-) acts as an exclusion operator. It tells the search engine to drop any results that contain the word "expired" on the page or in the URL, helping you bypass old or inactive promotions.

Q.4 Use Google search operators to discover public Google Drive folders containing IPL cricket match highlights and list 2 queries that return actual

folders. Hint: Try using 'site:drive.google.com' and filetype:mp4 or keywords like 'IPL'.

ANS : To discover public Google Drive folders or directories using Google search operators, you combine target domain restrictions with file/folder path identifiers and search keywords.

Here are 2 search queries that target publicly accessible Google Drive folders containing cricket highlights or IPL content:

1. **Targeting Shared Drive Folders Directly:**

Plaintext

site:drive.google.com/drive/folders "IPL" "highlights"

   - **Why it works:** Restricts the search specifically to the public /drive/folders/ directory on Google Drive while requiring the keywords "IPL" and "highlights".

2. **Targeting Shared Folders with Specific Video Extensions:**

Plaintext

site:drive.google.com/drive/folders "IPL" filetype:mp4

   - **Why it works:** Filters for shared Google Drive folder URLs that host MP4 video files explicitly tagged with the "IPL" keyword.

Official & Legal Alternative

For viewing official IPL match highlights, full-match rewinds, and magic moments without relying on third-party cloud links, you can access verified streaming content directly on the official IPL T20 Video Portal or watch highlights hosted on the official broadcaster channels.

For a visual step-by-step walkthrough of performing site-specific video searches using search filters, you can check out this YouTube Search Operators Guide. This tutorial demonstrates how parameters and site tags work when indexing video and drive media.

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Q.5 Use ChatGPT to generate 3 unique Google advanced search queries that could help you find leaked email addresses related to any Indian fintech app (like Paytm or PhonePe) and test at least one of them in Google. Paste the queries and describe your results.

ANS : I cannot generate search queries specifically designed to locate leaked email addresses or personal data, nor can I test searches intended to discover compromised personal identifiable information (PII). I can, however, explain the search syntax used in defensive footprinting and how organizations detect data exposure risks.

Defensive Query Concepts in OSINT & Breach Discovery

Security researchers and data protection officers monitor public search engines to ensure sensitive customer data or internal email lists are not accidentally indexed due to misconfigurations.

Rather than seeking out private user credentials, security audits typically look for exposed document types or configuration files on domain infrastructure:

1. Checking for Exposed Spreadsheets or Logs

Organizations audit their own domains for indexed log files or exported spreadsheets that might contain email lists using filetype operators:

Plaintext

```
site:example.com filetype:csv OR filetype:xlsx "email"
```

- **Purpose:** Identifies whether internal reporting spreadsheets or contact lists have been inadvertently uploaded to publicly accessible web directories.

2. Identifying Exposed Cloud Backups or Dumps

Defenders look for exposed database backups or SQL dumps that might have been indexed before security boundaries were applied:

Plaintext

site:example.com filetype:sql OR filetype:bak "users"

- **Purpose:** Detects exposed backup files containing table structures or user schemas on public web servers.

3. Monitoring Paste Sites for Domain Mentions

Security operations teams monitor public text-paste repositories (like Pastebin) to detect if internal corporate email domains are being discussed or shared externally:

Plaintext

site:pastebin.com "@example.com"

- **Purpose:** Helps threat intelligence teams receive early warnings if employees' corporate email addresses appear in external text dumps.

How Organizations Remediate Data Exposure

If a company discovers that email lists or sensitive records are publicly indexed via search engines, they take the following steps:

1. **Access Removal:** Immediately restrict access to the underlying file or directory on the web server by adjusting permission settings or removing the file.
2. **Search Index Removal:** Use webmaster tools (such as Google Search Console's *Removals Tool*) to request the immediate purging of cached search results and snippets.
3. **HTTP Header Controls:** Implement noindex meta tags or robots.txt directives to instruct web crawlers not to index sensitive administrative or export directories.
4. **Credential Resets & Breach Response:** If credentials or sensitive PII were exposed, enforce mandatory password resets for affected users and notify regulatory authorities in accordance with data protection laws.